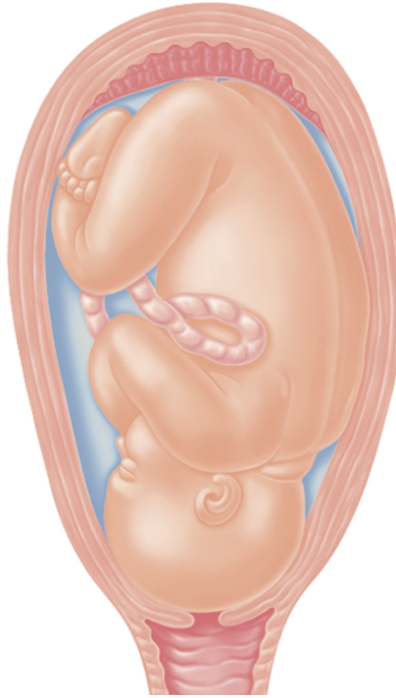
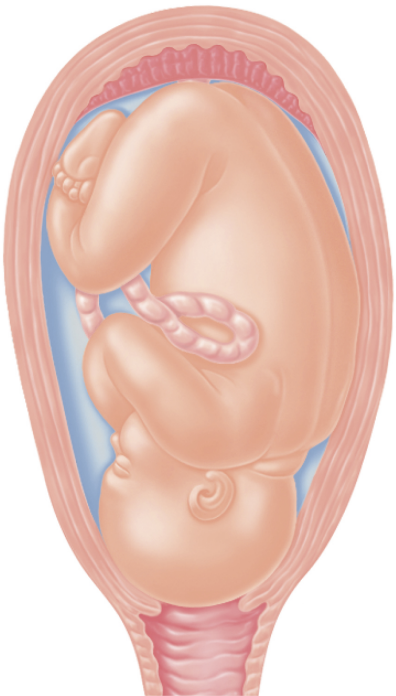




At 2 cm dilation, the cervix has shortened and is beginning to open. Contractions may still be irregular at this stage of your labor.



At 6 cm dilation, you are in active labor. Your contractions will be more frequent, regular, and stronger.